Taiwan Earnings Call Weekly Recap - Is Earnings Still Enough to Drive Stock Price? | GSTW

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Short week but busy for Taiwan in terms of earnings. Index is only down 1.8% WTD, though multiple large caps saw over 10% drawdown in this week alone. The elevated level in Taiwan vs other regional markets still attracted much short interest without much buying interest except from retail. Overall sentiment is not bearish, though investors have turned much more defensive and hiding in sectors such as Financials, Telecom, and TSMC.

For earnings, winners' momentum was short lived; instead of chasing into the beat, many chose to further profit take on the strength (Unimicron, EMC/TUC, Landmark on open right after their earnings). Companies that missed the results were definitely punished (i.e. Chroma, Delta, UMC). Echoing back to my previous note, range bound trade seems to be the safest way to stay afloat.

See below for my single stock takeaway:

Mediatek (2454 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 revenue reached NT$168.06bn (+10% QoQ and +18% YoY) with EPS at NT$17.5 (+15% QoQ and +11% YoY) vs cons. NT$15.95. GM came in at 46.3% (+11ppt QoQ and 18ppt YoY) vs cons. 46.2%.
- 3Q26 outperformance was mainly from stronger-than-expected customer demand and improved supply chain yield. First ASIC already started shipping since Sep'26.

Operational Outlook:

- Revenue outlook for 4Q26 is NT$210 - NT$222bn, translating to a 29% sequential growth. 2027 revenue growth will likely grow by high single digits yoy. GM will be around 45% with +/-1.5%, and OPM is expected to be at 26% +/-2%.
- ASIC chip sales for 2026 will be around US$2.5bn, higher than previous guidance, and it will reach US$16bn in 2027, around 20% of ASIC TAM and at the higher end of the company guidance. Next gen chip's tape out is on track and targeted to enter mass production in 1Q28.

Delta Electronics (2308 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 revenue reached NT$197.1bn (+8% QoQ / +31% YoY), while EPS registered at NT$9.05. GM declined to 34.1% (down 1.5ppt QoQ), impacted by a NT$3.9bn inventory write-down (~1.7% of revenue) mostly in Power Electronics.
- Operating profit rose +7% QoQ (+31% YoY) backed by operating leverage, keeping OPM resilient at 16.6% flat QoQ. Net profit was NT$23.5bn (-7% QoQ / +26% YoY) due to lower non-operating investment gains.

Operational Outlook:

- Management expects 4Q26 revenue to grow sequentially with gross margins unlikely to deteriorate, aided by inventory normalization and potential price adjustments to offset ~2% YTD material cost inflation.
- AI-related exposure approaches 50% of total revenue (liquid cooling at ~13%), and management remains confident in AI infrastructure demand through 2030 despite near-term bottlenecks.

Key Q&A:

- Inventory Write-down & Normalization: The NT$3.9bn write-down stemmed from component mismatches and slower customer ramp-ups of newer platforms (e.g., 18.5kW vs. 5.5kW platforms); management expects affected inventory to be progressively consumed by 1Q27.
- HVDC Adoption & Vicor Litigation: While 400V products saw partial shipments in 3Q26, 800V adoption is slower and primarily NVIDIA-driven. On the Vicor VPD patent dispute, management expects no near-term impact on customer relationships or shipments, with an initial ITC determination unlikely until 2027.

ASE Technology Holding (3711 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 consolidated revenue reached NT$244.16bn, with a GM of 22.1% and EPS of NT$5.84, all outperforming market expectations.
- ATM (Advanced Semiconductor Engineering, Test and Materials) GM hit 30.6%, breaking past previous structural highs; the company announced 30% as its baseline gross margin for the future.

Operational Outlook:

- 4Q26 consolidated revenue is projected to grow 6%–8% QoQ, with GM between 23.0%–24.0% and OPM between 14.5%–15.5%.
- CPO is set to enter mass production in 4Q26, with related revenue expected to contribute over US$500mn in 2027; the full-year LEAP revenue target has been revised upward to over US$4bn.

Key Q&A:

- Capex Upward Revision: Due to strong demand for LEAP and mainstream advanced packaging, full-year 2026 capex was raised from US$10.5bn to US$11.5bn (60% allocated to LEAP, 40% to mainstream packaging), with 2027 capex expected to be even higher.
- Capacity Bottlenecks & Expansion: Factory floor space is currently the primary constraint on near-term growth. The company is actively searching for and acquiring existing facilities to shorten setup timelines, prioritizing resource allocation toward packaging and wafer sort.

Elite Material (2383 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- Driven by strong demand, actual 3Q26 revenue grew 29% QoQ, comfortably beating prior conservative expectations.
- GM outperformed expectations, hitting 37.7% for the quarter.

Operational Outlook:

- 4Q26 revenue growth is conservatively estimated to be at least 15%–20% QoQ, with gross margins expanding further to 38.0%–39.5%.
- Proactive capacity expansion plans (targeting 15.25 million sheets/month by end-2030 vs. 5.85 million sheets/month currently) are still insufficient to support all signed Long-Term Agreements (LTAs) for the next 4 years, pointing to a severe supply-demand gap and zero oversupply risk.

Key Q&A:

- CCL Pricing & Substrate Expansion: EMC is executing its second round of high-end CCL (M7+) price hikes this year (5%–20% increases covering M7/M8 and M8+/M9 grades). Furthermore, it is rapidly expanding high-end ABF substrate core-layer CCL capacity from 300k sheets/month to at least 1.2 million sheets/month by end-2027, targeting commercial shipments starting in 4Q27.
- Competition & Market Share: While AI customers are qualifying second or third sources to secure supply chains, EMC maintains its long-term target of holding a 50% AI CCL market share, supported by best-in-class product quality and deep CSP/PCB collaboration.

Yageo Corporation (2327 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 revenue reached NT$49.53bn (+11.4% QoQ, +49.7% YoY), with a GM of 41% and EPS of NT$5.83.
- Free cash flow surged to NT$9.236 billion, while the net financial debt-to-EBITDA ratio dropped from 59% in 4Q25 to 24% in 3Q26, reflecting a continuously improving financial structure and robust cash generation.

Operational Outlook:

- 4Q26 revenue, GM, and OPM are all expected to edge up sequentially, defying typical seasonal flat-to-down trends for the fourth quarter.
- AI demand remains solid, with its contribution to total revenue expanding from 15% in 1Q26 and 16% in 2Q26 to approximately 20% in 3Q26.

Key Q&A:

- Capacity & Expansion Plans: Capacity utilization rates stood at 95% in 3Q26 and are expected to exceed 95% in 4Q26, surpassing the healthy range of 85%–90%. Total capacity for tantalum capacitors and MLCCs is planned to expand by 10%–15% in 2027, with portions coming online starting in the second quarter.
- Order Momentum & B/B Ratio: The overall book-to-bill (B/B) ratio in 3Q26 remained close to 2.0, with AI-related tantalum capacitors and MLCCs seeing particularly robust orders, while LTAs with core customers continue to underpin future shipments.

Nan Ya Plastics (1303 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 revenue rose to NT$95.6bn (+14.3% QoQ), with electronic materials expanding to 58.1% of total sales. Operating profit surged 61.2% QoQ to NT$18.31bn, of which electronic materials contributed 93.8%.
- EPS hit a record NT$4.90, bringing 9M26 EPS to a record NT$10.07, supported by electronic material profitability and investment income from Nanya Technology.

Operational Outlook:

- CCL has surpassed NYPCB as the segment's primary revenue driver (31% of electronic materials) with segment OPM scaling to 30.9% (up from 19.9% in 2Q26).
- Management guided for fiberglass fabrics and CCL price hikes to continue at a 5–10% MoM increase pace through early 2027, alongside a notable product mix shift toward M7/M8 in 1Q27.

Key Q&A:

- CCL Pricing and M-Series Mix: CCL and fiberglass-cloth pricing remains firm into early 2027 with monthly 5–10% increases. M-series products reached ~30% of CCL revenue in September, with management expecting further mix improvement toward M7/M8 as CSP projects lock in.
- Capacity Expansion and M10 Development: Monthly CCL capacity is projected to expand from 6.18m to 6.48m sheets by year-end. For M9/M10, Nan Ya is independently formulating hydrocarbon resins and fiberglass incorporating low-dielectric and quartz materials with solid sampling progress.

TUC (6274 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 financial results beat market consensus, reporting revenue of NT17.95bn, GM of 36.9%, operating margin of 31.0%, and EPS of NT$12.88, outperforming consensus estimates by 29% to 35%.
- The earnings beat was driven by continuous growth in high-end product revenue and a return to profitability for the Thailand plant, which successfully offset earlier first-half losses.

Operational Outlook:

- For 4Q26, high-end product pricing is initiating upward adjustments. With the Thailand plant adding another 100k sheets of capacity and all series of CCL seeing price hike opportunities (especially high-end M7/M8 catch-up price increases alongside tightening mid-to-low-end fiberglass cloth supply), product mix and profitability are set to improve further.
- ASIC AI servers are emerging as a core growth engine, alongside long-term opportunities from satellite and space data centers. TUC is adding several large ASIC customers (some already in sampling/board qualification stages) and expanding its customer base in 400G, 800G, and 1.6T switches.

Key Q&A / Detailed Highlights:

- ASIC & Switch Expansion: AI servers will serve as the primary growth driver, with multiple major ASIC clients entering the board-maker certification stage; meanwhile, existing 400G switch customers are rapidly accelerating 800G and 1.6T switch certifications, with some expecting 1.6T demand to outpace 800G by 2027.
- Satellite and PTFE Solutions: Space satellite PCBs utilizing M8+ materials are slated to begin contribution in 1H27, with long-term customer demand forecasts already extended through 2032. For PTFE, TUC boasts ~5–6 years of R&D foundation rather than being a newcomer, though external partnerships may be pursued to bypass special high-temperature press machine capacity limitations

Win Semiconductors (3105 TT)

Financial Highlights:

- 3Q26 revenue reached NT$5.86bn (+11.5% QoQ / +31% YoY) with capacity utilization improving to 75%. GM expanded significantly by 9.2ppts QoQ to an 18-quarter high of 37.4% (standalone GM reached 40.7%), while OPM rose to 24.2% and EPS reached NT$4.55.
- Margin expansion was primarily driven by a favorable product mix shift toward higher-margin Infrastructure and Optical products rather than utilization gains alone.

Operational Outlook:

- Management guided 4Q26 revenue for low-single-digit QoQ growth—beating normal smartphone seasonality—with gross margins sustaining in the high-30% range.
- Moving into FY27, photodetector (PD) production is expected to ramp materially, while CW Laser and EML are anticipated to contribute more meaningfully starting in FY28[cite: 388].

Key Q&A:

- Infrastructure and Satellite Growth: Infrastructure became WIN's largest revenue contributor at 35–40% in 3Q26, driven by LEO satellites, aerospace, and long-distance communications; demand is expected to stay robust into FY27.
- Optical and PD Production Timeline: Optical revenue rose QoQ on initial PD mass production; PD will see significantly higher full-year shipment volumes in FY27, while CW Laser and EML will generate limited initial revenue before a FY28 volume ramp.

Please feel free to reach out to your GS representative to discuss any ideas.

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